

6.3 Limitations

GCK is presently available only in the US. Unlike PayPal, it is not possible to transfer money between individuals; GCK only allows transfers between merchants who have registered at GCK and users. One oft-repeated comment about the service is the absence of any redirection after the purchase is complete. Ideally, after the user has confirmed the payment on the GCK site, he should be redirected to the merchant site or any site from which he came from. Unfortunately, in GCK, the user is left with just a thank you note from Google.

Concluding Remarks

Google, it would appear, has launched GCK cautiously. The scale of the operation seems to suggest that expansion will be a slow process. While there are few features that differentiate GCK and PayPal (apart from the fact that two non-merchant individuals can't send each other money), the fact that AdWords is a major player in online advertising and that Google is offering discounts to its AdWords users would help GCK find takers.